

Mount Etna Child & Family Services Inc. O/A Mount Etna Child & Family Services

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK



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Employee Handbook Issues And Updates

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Introduction

WELCOME TO OUR TEAM

Mount Etna Child & Family Services (“we” or the “Business”) would like to wish you every success during your employment whether you recently joined us, or you are an existing employee. We hope that your experience here will be positive and rewarding.

This Employee Handbook (“Handbook”) contains a summary of our workplace policies and procedures. This Handbook contains important information about working conditions in our Business. It also explains the standards and expectations all employees are expected to meet during their employment. Please review this Handbook in its entirety and ensure that you are familiar with its contents. Having a working knowledge of this document will greatly assist you in carrying out your day-to-day duties and responsibilities. Should you have any questions about the information contained in this Handbook, please do not hesitate to contact our management team.

Over time, and as the needs of our Business change, our policies and procedures will have to be updated and revised. While we reserve the right to make changes to this Handbook without notice to you, we will try to communicate any such amendments as soon as possible. Also, it may be necessary for us to modify this Handbook from time to time because of changes in law.

This Handbook shall be interpreted and applied in accordance with the Ontario *Employment Standards Act, 2000*, and the regulations as amended from time to time (collectively referred to as the “ESA” or the “Act”).

For further clarity, should any provision of this Handbook conflict with the provisions of the ESA, or any other applicable legislation, then the provisions of the ESA or other applicable legislation shall prevail.

Similarly, should the ESA, or any other applicable legislation, impose any requirement not included in this policy, or if the ESA, or any other applicable legislation, is amended so as to provide greater or lesser benefits, or impose greater or lesser obligations, than those set out in this Policy, then the provisions of the ESA, and all other applicable legislation shall prevail.

After you have read this Handbook in its entirety and have familiarized yourself with its contents, please sign the Employee Acknowledgement Form found at Schedule “A” of this document and submit it to management.

Joining Our Business

OUR PHILOSOPHY

The Business strives to maintain a workplace that fosters personal and professional growth for all employees. We also aim to ensure that all staff members are treated fairly and with dignity.

Thus, it is the responsibility of the Business and its employees to:

- Cooperate and communicate;
- Encourage and consider opinions of other employees and invite their participation in decisions that affect their careers;
- Encourage the growth and development of fellow workers by helping them achieve both personal and professional goals;
- Strive to avoid workplace conflict, and if it occurs, resolve it quickly and fairly;
- Administer all policies and procedures equitably and fairly; and,
- Recognize that each employee has the right to be treated fairly and with dignity.

CODE OF CONDUCT

The Business strives to provide a welcoming and professional environment for its employees, clients and visitors. This policy sets out the employee responsibilities for ensuring that all employees and clients have a high-quality experience.

- Employees should treat clients with respect and professionalism.
- Employees should avoid the use of vulgar or profane language, as well as excessive loudness.
- Respect clients regardless of age, gender, race, national origin, sexual orientation, religion, socioeconomic status, body type, political affiliation, state of health or personal habits.
- Employees should not spread gossip, rumours or engage in behaviour that creates friction and threatens the well-being of other employees or clients.

AN EQUAL OPPORTUNITY EMPLOYER

We are an equal opportunity employer and employ personnel without regard to race, colour, gender identity, gender expression, physical disability, mental disability, age, ancestry, place of origin, ethnic origin, citizenship, creed, sex, record of offences, marital status, family status or sexual orientation.

It is our policy to select the best qualified person for each position within our organization based on demonstrated ability, experience, training and potential. This policy applies to all our employment and personnel practices, including decisions regarding hiring, transfer, promotion, demotion and dismissal.

In addition, the Business pays compensation based on comparable value and does not discriminate in employment based on gender.

BACKGROUND CHECKS

The Business reserves the right to require applicants and existing employees to consent to background checks to ensure staff members possess the requisite skills.

Background checks may include, but are not limited to:

- Criminal background and police checks
- Credit checks
- Academic and professional reference checks
- Any other inquiries required and/or permitted by law

Existing employees may be asked to consent to background checks in the event of changes to their employment, such as transfers, promotions or modifications to their duties.

It is important that the information that is provided to us is complete and accurate. Any misrepresentation, falsification or material omission of information provided to us may result in the rescission of a conditional offer of employment or discipline up to and including dismissal.

DRESS CODE POLICY

Overview

We recognize the diversity of our employees and will make reasonable efforts to accommodate requests for an exception to this policy, while having regard for our business needs.

This policy is not exhaustive in defining acceptable and unacceptable standards of dress and appearance. Staff should use common sense in adhering to the overall intention of this policy, as explained above.

Application

This policy applies to all employees as well as temporary agency workers, volunteers, students, trainees, and apprentices (if applicable). Failure to adhere to our standards of dress and appearance may result in discipline.

Any questions about appropriate clothing, appearance, or grooming should be addressed to an employee's management. The management team is responsible for ensuring that this policy is followed.

Dress & Grooming Code

The Business has established a casual dress code to allow employees to work comfortably and efficiently while maintaining a professional and approachable appearance. Employees must ensure they always look presentable and professional, even when working virtually. Clothing with inappropriate logos or slogans, as well as attire that is ripped, torn, stained, or excessively revealing, is not permitted. Outfits should allow for ease of movement while engaging with children and maintaining a polished image that reflects the values and professionalism of the daycare.

Workplace Responsibilities & Clinical Environment

Employees may be required to perform reasonable tasks that support a safe, organized, and respectful clinical environment. These duties may fall outside direct clinical work and include, but are not limited to, light cleaning, tidying shared spaces, basic maintenance, and supporting colleagues as needed. Maintaining the environment and supporting one another are considered essential components of a healthy workplace.

Meetings & Attendance

Employees may be required to attend meetings scheduled during regular working hours. In addition, the Business may require attendance of up to one or two (1–2) mandatory meetings annually outside of regular working hours, including evenings or weekends, with reasonable advance notice provided wherever possible. Attendance at such meetings will be considered hours of work and will be compensated in accordance with the Applicable Employment Standards Legislation.

Hours of Work, Overtime, Holidays & Vacation

HOURS OF WORK

Our regular Business hours are typically as follows (except for holidays):

Monday to Friday: 9:00 AM to 7:00 PM
Saturday and Sunday: 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM.

Our regular hours may be subjected to change to adhere to the needs of the Business.

All employees are expected to work their assigned shift, including an unpaid half-hour lunch break. Employees may also be expected to work other hours as may be requested or required from time to time in order to meet the needs and objectives of the Business.

The Business reserves the right to alter the regular work week and regular work hours at any time, although we will provide as much advance notice as possible.

Where applicable under the ESA, the employee is required to take a 30-minute unpaid rest period after five (5) consecutive hours of work. The precise scheduling of rest periods will be determined by management and are subject to the needs of the Business.

OVERTIME

General

Unless ineligible under the ESA, employees may be entitled to overtime pay for working a certain number of hours in a week, as set out in the ESA. Furthermore, unless an employee's contract of employment states otherwise, overtime pay will be paid at one and a half (1.5) times an employee's regular rate of pay.

Employees must always receive prior written approval from their manager before working overtime. Employees who work overtime without the approval of management will be subject to discipline.

Abuse of the overtime policy is considered serious misconduct and will result in discipline up to and including dismissal.

Managers & Supervisors

Managers and supervisors do not qualify for overtime. Even if they perform other kinds of tasks that are not managerial or supervisory, they do not get overtime pay if these tasks are performed only on an irregular or exceptional basis.

Travel

Business Travel

Business travel on a non-workday will be paid in accordance with the ESA. Travel time may be paid at a different rate of pay from the employee's usual rate but will be at least the minimum wage under the ESA.

If travel is part of the employee's job or could be reasonably expected to occur while performing one's duties, it is work time. Some travel, which may be exceptional to the employee's normal duties, will be paid in accordance with the ESA.

Travel to and from work

Travelling to and from work does not qualify as work time.

"Banking" Overtime

If both an employee and the Business agree in writing, an employee may receive paid time off instead of overtime pay. This is called "banked" time or "time off in lieu".

Time off in lieu is earned at the rate of one and a half (1.5) hours of paid time off work for each hour of overtime worked.

Paid time off must be taken within three (3) months of the end of the work week in which it was earned or, with the employee's agreement, within twelve (12) months of that work week. However, any banked time must be taken on a date mutually agreed upon in advance by the Business and the employee.

PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

The Business adheres to the public holiday provisions of the ESA, as amended from time to time, and will administer this policy in accordance with the requirements of the Act. Eligible employees are entitled to the following 9 public holidays stated in the ESA with pay:

- New Year's Day
- Family Day
- Good Friday
- Victoria Day
- Canada Day
- Labour Day
- Thanksgiving Day
- Christmas Day
- Boxing Day

As an additional benefit, employees have the option to take Easter Monday and the Civic Holiday off. Employees may choose to take these days **unpaid** or use their available paid time off.

The Business reserves the right to close its office during designated low-season periods, including the last week of August, the first week of September, and the last two weeks of December. Employees may choose to take these days **unpaid** or use their available paid time off.

This policy will be reviewed annually and will depend on operational requirements.

Holiday Pay

Employees who qualify for public holiday pay under the ESA will receive holiday pay calculated in accordance with the Act.

If an employee agrees to work on a holiday in accordance with the Act, they shall be compensated in accordance with the Act.

In any event, this policy shall always be applied in accordance with the ESA and under no circumstances will an employee receive less than their full entitlements under the ESA, as amended from time to time.

VACATION

Vacation Time

All employees are required to take their vacation time in the anniversary year in which the vacation time is earned.

Each employee's vacation entitlement, and the method for determining that entitlement, will be specifically set out in the employee's contract of employment. If not, it will be determined in accordance with the ESA.

You will not be permitted to carry vacation time over to a subsequent year unless you obtain approval in writing from management. However, at no time will you receive less than your vacation entitlements under the ESA.

Scheduling Vacations

All vacation requests must be made by submitting to management a completed Form A (Vacation Request Form), which can be found in the Appendix hereto. All requests for vacation must be submitted for approval at least 30 days before the start of the proposed vacation period.

All vacations must be approved by management in advance. While the Business will make every effort to accommodate employee vacation requests, the timing of an employee's vacation is ultimately subject to management's discretion and the needs of the business.

Furthermore, the Business reserves the right to withdraw approval for a vacation should business circumstances require it. However, should that occur, we will make reasonable efforts to minimize any inconvenience or hardship to the employee.

There is a vacation cap of one employee depending on the needs of the business.

Leaves of Absence

STATUTORY LEAVES OF ABSENCE

The ESA sets out several different statutory leaves of absence that can be taken by employees. For a complete list and details regarding each leave, please consult the ESA under Part 14.

When an employee takes a statutory leave of absence, the employee must make management aware by submitting a **Form B** (Statutory Leave Notice Form), notifying the manager in writing, or both.

Below are the available statutory leaves prescribed by the ESA that require employees to submit a Form B **and** notify management in writing prior to commencing the leave:

- Bereavement Leave
- Family Responsibility Leave
- Sick Leave
- Pregnancy and Parental Leave
- Reservist Leave
- Organ Donor Leave

Employees must notify their manager in writing as soon as is reasonable before taking the above statutory leaves by submitting a completed Form B, which can be found in the Appendix hereto. However, if, due to their circumstances, they must commence the leave before notifying management, they must submit the completed Form B as soon as possible.

Also, we may require that the employee provides evidence reasonable in the circumstances that they were entitled to the leave.

Below are the available statutory leaves prescribed by the ESA that require employees to notify management in writing prior to commencing the leave:

- Domestic or Sexual Violence Leave
- Family Medical Leave
- Critical Illness Leave
- Child Death Leave
- Crime-Related Child Disappearance Leave
- Family Caregiver Leave
- Emergency Leave

Employees must notify their manager in writing as soon as is reasonable before taking the above statutory leaves of absence. However, if, due to their circumstances, they must commence the leave before notifying management, they must do so as soon as possible.

EFFECT OF A LEAVE

The purposes of the foregoing leaves, their length, and eligibility criteria vary. An employee may be entitled to more than one leave for the same event. Each leave is separate and the right to each leave is independent of any right an employee may have to the other leave(s).

Please read the ESA for a detailed explanation of your leave entitlements.

Unless otherwise required by law, while an employee is on a leave, their terms of employment will remain the same and the Business will continue to pay its share of the premiums required to maintain benefits, if any, which were available to the employee prior to the leave. However, if an employee on leave elects in writing not to continue participating in any applicable benefit plans while on a leave of absence, the Business will not continue to make its employer's contributions to the benefit plans while the employee remains on leave.

OTHER LEAVES OF ABSENCE

The Business recognizes that there may be times when employees need to take a leave of absence from work for reasons other than those identified above. While it is impossible to define all the circumstances in which an employee will require time away from work, this policy is intended to provide some general guidelines.

Sick/Wellness Days

The Business offers 3 paid sick/wellness days per calendar year to support employees' health and well-being. These days are intended to provide flexibility for employees to address short-term personal health needs without impacting their regular income. Sick/wellness days do not carry over to the following year and must be used within the calendar year they are provided.

The Business will consider, among other things, the following factors when it receives requests for a leave of absence not otherwise legislated:

- Previous requests for a leave of absence;
- The availability of suitable replacement staff;
- The time of year at which the request is made; and,
- The purposes of the leave.

All requests for a leave of absence will be considered on an unpaid basis and without a continuation of benefits, unless otherwise stated and expressly indicated in writing by the Business or required by law.

If an employee wishes to request an additional leave of absence, they must provide at least 30 days' notice to their manager by submitting a completed **Form C** (Non-Statutory Leave Notice Form), which can be found in the Appendix hereto. However, if, due to their circumstances, the employee must commence a leave before notifying management, then they must submit the completed Form C as soon as possible.

Attendance Policy and Scheduling

Employees are required to report to work in accordance with their approved schedules. This includes maintaining regular attendance and arriving to work for their scheduled start time.

CALL IN PROCEDURES

In the event of an absence, employees are required to call in/text/email to report the absence to their manager at least 2 (two) hours before their scheduled start time. If an absence can be scheduled in advance, an employee is required to do so in writing to their manager.

Where it is impossible for an employee to report an absence because of hospitalization or for other emergency related reasons, the employee may have a family member or friend report the absence at the first available opportunity.

In the event of a late arrival, employees are required to text to report their late arrival to their manager as soon as possible.

If an employee must leave work early, they must notify their manager as soon as possible. The employee will be expected to make up the lost time during the work week in which the early departure occurs.

If late arrivals or early departures can be scheduled in advance, an employee is required to do so in writing to their supervisor.

MEDICAL DOCUMENTATION

Employees may be required to provide medical documentation (at the employee's expense) after they have exhausted their annual Sick Leave entitlement under the ESA.

CULPABLE ABSENTEEISM

An employee may be disciplined up to and including dismissal for culpable absenteeism. Culpable absenteeism refers to absences that are "blameworthy" in the sense that they involve the unjustified withdrawal of services by an employee – for example, failing to show up for work on time or failing to request and/or report an absence in accordance with this policy.

ABSENCES FOR APPOINTMENTS

All appointments (e.g. doctor/dentist appointment, etc.) should be scheduled outside of normal working time. Time off for appointments that can only be scheduled during working hours must be approved by the employee's manager.

Discipline Policy

The Business is committed to fair and constructive treatment of unacceptable work performance. The following progressive discipline process will, where appropriate, be carried out with the intent of improving employee behaviour and/or performance.

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Deal with allegations of misconduct fairly.
- Encourage employee improvement through continuing education and supervision.
- Ensure that discipline is proportionate to the seriousness of the misconduct.
- Reserve the Business' right to terminate employment immediately where misconduct is severe and incompatible with continued employment.
- Ensure disciplinary measures are consistent with the Business' obligations under the ESA.

This policy applies to all employees. It does not apply to independent contractors/consultants.

All incidents or allegations of misconduct will be investigated before the Business proceeds with disciplinary measures. The depth of investigation required will depend on the nature of an incident or allegations and will vary case to case.

IDENTIFICATION OF PERFORMANCE ISSUES

The employee's manager is responsible for promptly identifying and responding to any unsatisfactory conduct or performance by the employee. Before initiating our progressive discipline process, the manager shall first communicate our expectations to the employee both verbally and in writing so that the employee is fully aware of the standards expected of him or her and that failure to comply with those standards will result in discipline.

The Business may place an employee on a performance improvement plan at any time, including before or during the four-step progressive discipline policy as detailed below.

PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINE

If the employee's performance continues to fall short of acceptable standards or if the employee commits a serious initial act of misconduct, such as violating the rules set out in this policy, the employee's supervisor shall initiate the progressive discipline policy, which involves a verbal warning, a written warning, a final written warning, and a dismissal if management deems appropriate.

Each stage of progressive discipline has the aim of impressing on the employee the seriousness of misconduct, communicating expectations regarding future conduct, and offering the employee an opportunity to improve.

The Business, in its sole discretion, reserves the right to bypass any and all of the below progressive discipline steps as deemed appropriate. The Business will assess all employee performance and behaviour-based issues on a case-by-case basis and may treat each issue differently in accordance with the severity and/or frequency of the issue.

Step One: Verbal Warning

The employee's manager shall meet privately with the employee to discuss their performance issues and warn the employee that failure to correct their conduct could lead to further discipline up to and including termination of employment. A note regarding the details of the verbal warning will be placed in the employee's personal file. The manager shall discuss with the employee ways to bring about improvements in the employee's performance.

If the Business determines that it is appropriate, the employee will be placed on a performance improvement plan with the aim of helping the employee correct their behaviour and improve their work performance.

Step Two: Written Warning

If an employee's performance does not improve following Step 1, then the employee shall receive a written warning that their continued misconduct could lead to further disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. If so, a formal disciplinary letter will be given to the employee and placed in their personnel file. This letter will detail the employee's misconduct, expectation for improvement, and the consequences of further misconduct, including termination. The employee's manager will again discuss with the employee ways to bring about improvements in the employee's performance.

If the Business determines that it is appropriate, the employee will be placed on a new or updated performance improvement plan with the aim of helping the employee correct their behaviour and improve their work performance.

Step Three: Final Written Warning

The final written warning is the last time the employee will be issued a warning before the Business proceeds with terminating the employee.

During this step, the Business will require the employee to provide an explanation as to why their performance continues to suffer so the Business has a final chance to work with the employee before they are terminated. Similar to the previous steps, the employee's manager will discuss with the employee ways to bring about improvements in the employee's performance.

If the Business determines that it is appropriate, the employee will be placed on a new or updated performance improvement plan with the aim of helping the employee correct their behaviour and improve their work performance.

Step Four: Termination

If the employee's misconduct continues after Step 3, then the employee will be terminated.

EXCEPTION FOR SERIOUS MISCONDUCT

The Business reserves the right to dismiss an employee prior to carrying out any or all of the steps set out above where, in its sole discretion, we determine that the employee has engaged in serious and wilful misconduct – for example, theft, breach of confidentiality, workplace violence, discrimination and/or harassment.

Performance Review Policy

The Business is committed to providing constructive feedback and maintaining open communication with all employees. The Performance Review Policy (the “Policy”) provides a general overview of how employees are coached, evaluated, and rewarded.

SCOPE

The Policy applies to all employees of the Business.

POLICY STATEMENT

The performance management practices are designed to:

- Ensure employees understand their job responsibilities and have specific goals to meet.
- Provide employees with actionable and timely work feedback.
- Invest in development opportunities that help employees grow professionally.
- Recognize and reward employees.

GOOD PERFORMANCE

Generally, employees who do the following things are more likely to receive positive performance reviews:

- Consistently meet their targets.
- Complete their job duties as expected.
- Show a willingness to learn and develop.
- Follow the Business’s policies.
- Have a good attitude and collaborate well with colleagues.

REVIEWS

The Business conducts quarterly performance reviews. Managers will complete the performance review form and arrange a meeting with the employee to discuss the review. The goal of the discussion is to:

- Recognize employees for good performance
- Talk about career moves and employee motivations
- Identify areas of improvement

In addition to formal performance reviews, managers should meet with their employees regularly to provide feedback and discuss any other matters.

REWARDS

Pay increases or bonuses after a performance review are not guaranteed.

TRAINING

Training and development opportunities are available for all employees throughout the year and may be discussed during performance reviews.

If necessary, the Business may implement an improvement plan, on-the-job training, job shadowing, or other training methods to develop an employee.

MANAGERS' RESPONSIBILITIES

To conduct effective regular meetings and performance evaluations, managers are expected to:

- **Set clear objectives:** Employees should know what is expected of them. When an employee is first hired, they should understand their job duties. Specific goals for each employee (and team-wide, if applicable) should be set. Those goals should be renewed during formal performance reviews.
- **Provide useful feedback:** During scheduled meetings with employee(s), guidance and feedback should be provided, as appropriate. Fairness and specificity are important to help them understand and improve.
- **Keep employees involved:** There should be two-way communication between managers and their employees. Expectations should be clear, and employees' motivations and aspirations should be taken into account. Training and development opportunities should be discussed.
- **Keep logs about each employee:** These logs help evaluate the employee, but they may also prove useful in the case of a reward, promotion, or termination.

REVIEW OF THE POLICY

This Policy will be reviewed and may be amended from time to time based on the needs and experiences of the Business.

Company Equipment Policy

The Business provides employees with company equipment required to perform their job. The Company Equipment Policy (the “Policy”) ensures proper care and accountability in handling company equipment.

SCOPE

The Policy applies to all employees of the Business who have been provided with company equipment.

OWNERSHIP OF EQUIPMENT

All equipment issued to employees remains the property of the Business.

EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITIES

Employees who are issued equipment by the Business are responsible for the following:

- Safekeeping and properly caring for the equipment;
- Limiting use of the equipment to themselves;
- Limiting their use to work-related purposes for which the equipment was assigned, except when otherwise directed by management;
- Promptly reporting to their manager any loss of, damage to, or unserviceable condition of any equipment;
- Not attempting to repair any damaged or malfunctioning equipment without prior approval of a manager (unless it is part of their job);
- Not discarding or selling damaged or malfunctioning equipment without management written approval; and
- Securing equipment during transit.

LOSS/THEFT OF EQUIPMENT

Lost or stolen equipment must be immediately reported to management. If the equipment is stolen outside the Business’s premises, the employee must also report it to the police.

INTENTIONAL DAMAGE TO EQUIPMENT

Intentionally damaging company equipment (including the hardware or software) in any way may result in the loss of privileges and/or other discipline up to and including termination of employment.

The Business reserves the right to recover expenditures associated with intentional damage to equipment, in accordance with applicable laws.

An employee may voluntarily reimburse the Business for damaged equipment, which may be considered a mitigating factor in determining the extent of disciplinary action.

CONTRAVENTIONS OF THE POLICY

Contraventions of the Policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Company Credit Card Policy

The Business may, from time to time, provide employees with a company credit card to carry out their work duties. This Company Credit Card Policy (the “Policy”) sets out the rules and guidelines governing the use of a company credit card. This Policy applies to all employees of the Business who have been issued a company credit card.

Ownership and Issuance of Company Credit Cards

Company credit cards may only be issued by an authorized member of management, as determined by the Business in its sole discretion.

Company credit cards issued to employees are the property of the Business. Any points or other benefits accruing as a result of an employee’s use of a company credit card are the property of the Business.

Employee Responsibilities

An employee who is given a company credit card is responsible for:

- Ensuring that the card is only used for appropriate work expenditures (see Section below – Permitted Use of Company Credit Cards);
- Ensuring that the card is only used by the employee to whom it is issued;
- Retaining and submitting all supporting receipts for reconciliation via the KeepApp, and if requested, providing explanations for all card transactions. Non-compliance may result in the Business restricting or revoking the employee’s credit card access;
- Providing detailed transaction summaries or logs as requested by the Business;
- Promptly reporting the loss of or damage to the card; and
- Promptly returning the card immediately upon the termination of the employee’s employment for any reason.

Permitted use of Company Credit Cards

Employees are permitted to use company credit cards for the following purposes:

- Travel expenses;
- Meals and accommodation; and
- Tools, parts, equipment, clothing.

Improper use of Company Credit Cards

Examples of prohibited uses of company credit cards include, but are not limited to:

- Incurring personal expenses, including meals;
- Paying membership fees and dues;
- Cash withdrawals or cash advances; and
- Purchasing furniture, stationery or other chattels or equipment.

Contraventions of the Policy

Any contraventions of the policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Expense Policy

The Business will reimburse employees for reasonable expenses incurred for business purposes. The Expense Policy (the “Policy”) explains the Business’s expense reimbursement practices.

SCOPE

The Policy applies to all employees of the Company.

GENERAL

In order for an expense to be reimbursed under this Policy, employees must submit the appropriate supporting receipts.

EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT PROCEDURE

Employees must submit expense reimbursement claims by completing a claim form and submitting it to their manager within 7 days of incurring the expense. All supporting receipts must be attached to the claim. The claim will then be processed and paid on the next pay period.

CONTRAVENTIONS OF THE POLICY

Contraventions of the Policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

REVIEW OF THE POLICY

This Policy will be reviewed and may be amended from time to time based on the needs and experiences of our workplace.

Anti-Discrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy

ORGANIZATIONAL COMMITMENT

The Business is committed to providing an environment free of discrimination and harassment, in which all individuals are treated with respect, dignity and have equal opportunities.

Under the Ontario *Human Rights Code*, every person has the right to freedom from harassment and discrimination in employment.

Harassment and discrimination will not be tolerated, condoned, or ignored. If a claim of harassment or discrimination is proven, disciplinary measures will be applied against the offending employee(s), up to and including dismissal.

OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this policy are to:

- Ensure that all staff and clients are aware that harassment and discrimination are unacceptable practices and are incompatible with our standards, as well as being a violation of the law;
- Set out the types of behaviour that may be considered offensive and are prohibited by this policy; and,
- Promote appropriate standards of conduct at all times.

APPLICATION

The right to freedom from discrimination and harassment extends to all employees, including full-time, part-time, temporary and contract staff, as well as volunteers, co-op students, interns and apprentices.

It is also unacceptable for members of staff or contractors working on our behalf to engage in harassment or discrimination when dealing with clients, or with others with whom they have professional dealings, such as suppliers, service providers and potential clients.

This policy applies to every level of our organization and to every aspect of the workplace environment and employment relationship, including recruitment, selection, promotion, transfers, training, salaries, benefits, and termination. It also covers rates of pay, overtime, hours of work, holidays, discipline, and performance evaluations.

Furthermore, this policy applies to events that occur outside of the physical workplace, such as during Business trips and company parties.

Any violation of this policy or its related procedures may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, in accordance with the Business' Disciplinary Policy.

PROTECTED GROUNDS

This policy prohibits discrimination or harassment based on the protected grounds listed in the Ontario *Human Rights Code*, and any combination of such grounds.

DEFINITIONS OF PROHIBITED BEHAVIOUR

For the purposes of this policy:

- “Discrimination” means any form of unequal treatment based on a protected ground, whether imposing extra burdens or denying benefits. It may be intentional or unintentional. It may involve direct actions that are discriminatory on their face, or it may involve rules, practices or procedures that appear neutral, but have the effect of disadvantaging certain groups of people.
- “Harassment” means a course of vexatious comments or actions that are known, or ought to reasonably be known, to be unwelcome. It can involve words or actions that are known or should be known to be offensive, embarrassing, humiliating, demeaning, or unwelcome. Prohibited harassment is not necessarily based on any prohibited grounds.
- “Sexual Harassment” means:
 - engaging in a course of vexatious comment or conduct against a worker in a workplace because of sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or gender expression, where the course of comment or conduct is known or ought reasonably to be known to be unwelcome; and/or
 - making a sexual solicitation or advance where the person making the solicitation or advance is in a position to confer, grant or deny a benefit or advancement to the worker and the person knows or ought reasonably to know that the solicitation or advance is unwelcome.

Examples of Prohibited Behaviour

Examples of the type of behaviour prohibited by this policy include but are not limited to:

- Any form of sexual harassment, including touching, petting, pinching, kissing, unwelcome sexual flirtations, advances, requests, or invitations, leering or other suggestive gestures;
- The display of visual sexual material that is offensive, or which one ought to know, is offensive;
- Bullying;
- Demeaning and/or belittling comments;
- Nicknames, remarks, jokes or innuendos related to a protected ground;
- Obscene remarks or gestures;
- Display or circulation of offensive pictures, graffiti or materials, whether in print form or via e-mail or other electronic means;
- Singling out an individual for humiliating or demeaning teasing or jokes because they are a member of a protected group;
- Comments ridiculing an individual because of characteristics that are related to a protected ground; and,
- Creating a poisoned work environment through comments or conduct. The comments or conduct may not be directed at a specific individual, and may be from any individual, regardless of position or status. A single comment or action, if sufficiently serious may create a poisoned environment.

- Derogatory statements or sexually suggestive postings through the use any of information or communication technology, or online media including, but not limited to social media platforms such as Facebook, Microsoft Teams, X (also formerly known as Twitter), Instagram, TikTok, Snapchat, etc.).

What isn't Workplace Harassment or Discrimination?

Reasonable action or conduct by a manager or employee that is part of his/her normal work function will not normally be considered harassing or discriminatory. This is the case even if there are sometimes unpleasant consequences for an employee. Examples include:

- Changes in work assignments;
- Scheduling;
- Job assessment and evaluation;
- Workplace inspections;
- Implementation and enforcement of dress codes; and,
- Counselling/disciplinary action.

Differences of opinion or minor disagreements between co-workers will also generally not be considered workplace harassment.

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

All employees are expected to uphold and abide by this policy, by refraining from any form of harassment or discrimination, and by cooperating fully in any investigation of a harassment or discrimination complaint.

Managers have the additional responsibility to act immediately on observations or allegations of harassment or discrimination. Managers are responsible for creating and maintaining a harassment and discrimination-free organization and should address potential problems before they become serious.

Any employee who believes they have been subjected to workplace discrimination or harassment should report the matter to their manager for investigation in accordance with the procedures set out below. If an employee's manager is alleged to have engaged in workplace discrimination or harassment, the employee may report such matters to the next level of management.

COMPLAINTS PROCEDURE

Step One: Reporting

A report should include details about the alleged incident(s), including the date(s), time(s) and location(s), what happened, who was involved and the names of any witnesses.

If an emergency exists and the situation is one of immediate danger, then it should be immediately reported to the police by dialing "9-1-1" as soon as it is safe to do so. A person in a situation of immediate danger must at the same time take whatever steps are necessary to ensure their own safety and to protect themselves against harm or injury. Once an employee is safe, then he or she can then report the matter to management.

A manager in receipt of any report or complaint by an employee of workplace discrimination or harassment, or who otherwise becomes aware of any allegation of workplace discrimination or harassment, shall immediately notify the complaints officer.

Step Two: Workplace Investigation

The investigator, upon receipt of a complaint or allegation of workplace discrimination or harassment, shall conduct a prompt, thorough and confidential investigation into the allegation or complaint.

The Business will also conduct an investigation if it indirectly becomes aware of an incident of workplace harassment or discriminatory conduct, such as where an employee witnesses an incident of workplace harassment or discrimination or learns about it from a third party.

The Business may, at its discretion or where required, utilize the services of a third-party investigator, outside legal counsel, or such other external expertise as necessary in the circumstances.

Under no circumstances will a complaint or allegation be investigated by the individual who is the alleged harasser or by the individual who is alleged to have engaged in discriminatory conduct. Furthermore, under no circumstances will a complaint be investigated by an individual who is under the direct control of the alleged harasser or by an individual who is alleged to have engaged in discriminatory conduct.

The investigation procedure is as follows:

1. Interview with the complainant: The investigator will interview the complainant concerning the facts underlying their allegation(s).
2. Interview with the respondent: The investigator will interview the employee accused of committing the workplace discrimination or harassment. The employee will be asked for their response to the allegation(s) being made and for their side of the story.
3. Interviews with witnesses and other individuals: The investigator will then interview any other employees or individuals who may have witnessed the incidents of alleged workplace discrimination or harassment, or who may otherwise be able to provide information relevant to the investigation.
4. Records: The investigation will be documented, and the record will consist of, among other things, detailed notes of all interviews with employees and witnesses and all other information relevant to the investigation.
5. Report: The results of the investigation will be reported, in writing, to management. The results will include an assessment of the validity of the complaint.

Step Three: Action

The results of an investigation must be communicated in writing to the worker(s) who has/have claimed the alleged harassment or discrimination and to the alleged harasser, if he or she is a worker of the employer. Where an investigation results in disciplinary action, the complainant(s) and the respondent(s) will be informed in writing. If the investigation does not corroborate the complaint(s), then the complainant(s) and the respondent(s) will be advised in writing and the matter will be closed. It is important to note that the results of the investigation are not the same as the investigation report. The results of the investigation are a summary of the findings of the investigation.

If the investigation corroborates the complaint(s) to the satisfaction of the Business, then the Business will, among other things, take appropriate disciplinary action against the offending employee(s), and any other measures it deems necessary to properly address the incident and prevent future incidences of workplace discrimination and harassment. The nature and extent of any disciplinary or remedial action will be determined by the Business in its sole discretion and may include dismissal of the offending employee(s) for cause. The Business may require that a worker participate in an anger management program or other form of counselling, either voluntarily or as a condition of continued employment.

PROTECTION FROM RETALIATION

No retaliation or reprisals will be undertaken or tolerated against any employee who, in good faith, complains of, reports or participates in the investigation of any allegations of workplace discrimination or harassment.

EMPLOYEE COOPERATION

If it is necessary for the purposes of completing, carrying out or protecting the integrity of an investigation, or if it is necessary to maintain a work environment that is safe and free of harassment and discrimination, the Business may require an employee to remain out of the workplace while an investigation is being conducted.

The participation and cooperation of all employees is critical to the development and implementation of this policy. The refusal or failure of any employee to cooperate with the Business is a serious form of misconduct for which an employee may be disciplined up to and including dismissal.

CONFIDENTIALITY

The Business recognizes the difficulty of coming forward with a complaint of workplace discrimination or harassment and a complainant's interest in keeping the matter confidential. To protect the interests of the complainant, the respondent, persons who may report incidents of workplace harassment and the integrity of the process, confidentiality will be maintained throughout the process and information relating to the complaint will be disclosed only to the extent necessary for the purposes of investigating or taking corrective action with respect to the incident or complaint or is otherwise required by law.

All individuals involved in a workplace investigation are expected to keep the substance of the investigation strictly confidential. Unless otherwise set out in this policy, all records of complaints, including records of meetings, interviews, results of investigations and other relevant material, will be maintained in a confidential file and will be disclosed only to the extent necessary to carry out these procedures and where disclosure is required by law.

All such records will be retained in accordance with our privacy policy and procedures.

POLICY REVIEW

This policy shall be monitored on an ongoing basis and shall be reviewed annually.

Whistleblower Policy

The Business is committed to ensuring that it operates according to the highest standards of ethical conduct and in compliance with applicable laws and its internal policies. The purpose of this Whistleblower Policy (the “Policy”) is to set out the Business’ policy and procedures in respect of reporting and investigating allegations of breaches of ethical or legal duties.

SCOPE

This Policy applies to all employees, contractors, and volunteers of the Business, as well as its directors and officers.

DEFINITION OF INCIDENT

For the purpose of this Policy, a complaint may be submitted if any one of the following incidents occurs, is reasonably suspected to have occurred, or there are reasonable grounds to believe will occur (each an “Incident”):

- Accounting, auditing, or other financial reporting fraud or misrepresentation;
- Violations of federal or provincial laws that could result in criminal charges, fines, or civil and/or statutory liability payable by the Business, or that could otherwise significantly harm the Business’ reputation or public image;
- Unethical business conduct in violation of any of the Business’ policies;
- Danger to the health, safety, or well-being of employees, volunteers, contractors, and/or members of the public, or environmental damage.

All individuals subject to this Policy have a duty to report an Incident as soon as practicable.

PROCEDURE FOR REPORTING COMPLAINTS

Where an employee, volunteer, or contractor reasonably suspects that an Incident has occurred or will occur, the employee, volunteer, or contractor may submit a written complaint to the Business’ President, or, if the President is implicated in the complaint or unavailable, another director of the Business who is not implicated in the alleged Incident.

The written complaint should include the following information:

- Description of the alleged Incident
- Date complainant became aware of the alleged Incident
- Name of the individual suspected of engaging in or contemplating engaging in the alleged Incident
- Steps taken (if any) prior to making complaint

Individuals are not required to prove the truth of an allegation, but they are required to act in good faith, and to provide sufficient evidence to show that there is a reasonable basis for the complaint warranting an investigation.

All complaints will be treated confidentially and reviewed in a timely manner.

INVESTIGATION PROCEDURE

Once a complaint is received, an investigation will commence. The investigation will be conducted by a manager, officer, or director who is not implicated in the complaint, or, where that is not possible or where the involvement of any manager, officer, or director may give rise to the appearance of bias, the Business may, in its sole discretion, engage an outside party to act as investigator.

The investigator will interview all relevant personnel and review any evidence provided by the individual who made the complaint. All employees, volunteers, contractors, directors, and officers are required to cooperate with the investigator to the extent legally permissible.

The investigator may enlist the assistance of other employees, legal counsel, and other advisors as appropriate.

The investigator will prepare a report, and any legal or other action will be taken as appropriate. The results of the investigation will be shared with the complainant to the extent possible while respecting the privacy of individuals involved and the confidentiality of Business information.

Records pertaining to any complaint made pursuant to this Policy will be retained in compliance with applicable laws.

NO RETALIATION

Where an employee, volunteer, or contractor, in good faith and on reasonable grounds, reports an Incident pursuant to this Policy, the Business will not take any deleterious action against the employee, volunteer, or contractor as a result of such report. For greater certainty, employees, volunteers, and contractors will not be discharged, demoted, suspended, threatened, denied an opportunity or benefit, harassed, or in any other manner discriminated against as a result of reporting a genuine concern.

Where an individual believes that they have been retaliated against for submitting a complaint in good faith under this Policy, they may submit a follow-up complaint in respect of the alleged retaliation in accordance with the procedure for reporting complaints outlined in this Policy. The retaliation complaint will be investigated according to the investigation procedure set out in this Policy.

Any individual who is found to have retaliated against an individual for reporting a complaint in accordance with this Policy will be subject to discipline.

Nothing in this Policy restricts the Business from taking disciplinary action or steps to manage the performance of any employee, volunteer, or contractor for reasons that are not connected to a good faith complaint made pursuant to this Policy.

Where, after investigating a complaint, the Business reasonably concludes that an employee, volunteer, or contractor made an unfounded complaint in bad faith or without reasonable grounds, the employee, volunteer, or contractor will be subject to discipline, up to and including dismissal or termination of contract.

REVIEW OF THE POLICY

This Policy may be amended from time to time.

Accommodation Policy

The Business is committed to its duty to accommodate an employee and to actively engage in the accommodation process with employees, their physicians, and, where applicable, their representatives.

This policy covers all employees of the Business requiring short or long-term accommodation because of any injuries, disabilities, or illness originating on or off the job, or any other protected need or rights under applicable human rights legislation.

The process described in this policy applies when accommodation is requested and documented by an employee, by a qualified medical care provider or physician on behalf of an employee, or objectively determined and documented by management.

ACCOMMODATION PROCESS

The accommodation process involves a systematic and in-depth review of the job requirements and the limitations or performance problems the accommodation needs creates.

The purpose of this review is to identify changes or modifications that may allow the employee to perform the essential job duties free from workplace obstacles.

Accommodation is a shared responsibility between employees requesting accommodation and the Business.

A review to determine the feasibility, type and duration of accommodation involves an interactive process and dialogue that should involve at a minimum the employee requesting the accommodation and local management. Depending on the circumstances, the Business may also mandate a third party to help with the assessment of the available positions and determining the possible accommodations.

Each request for accommodation will be assessed on a case by case basis, considering, among other things, the employee's particular situation and the potential impact of the requested accommodation on the Business. This process may take several discussions to determine the feasibility, type and duration of accommodation. Other factors, including the employee's ability to perform the essential functions of his or her role with the accommodation and the reasonableness of the accommodation, will be considered.

If the Business determines that it cannot reasonably accommodate the employee's request, the employee's continued employment with the Business will be assessed based on applicable employment laws and regulations, the Business's policies and procedures, and any collective bargaining agreements. During continued employment, the Business will continue the interactive process towards identifying accommodation(s) that meets the needs of the employee and does not create an undue hardship on the Business.

The Business may require an employee to provide medical documentation supporting the requested accommodation. Acceptable documentation will clearly include the employee's specific functional limitations, the prognosis for recovery and the anticipated length of time the accommodation will be required. Vague or generic statements in documents are not acceptable. Examples of unacceptable statement include: "light duty", "cannot work full time", or "can only be assigned to [particular piece of equipment or task]". If an employee refuses to

provide this supporting documentation, the employee may not be entitled to reasonable accommodation.

The Business has the right to retain and use a medical professional of its choice to review and advise it on accommodation matters and to review relevant documentation and the employee has the obligation to cooperate with this process.

OUR RESPONSIBILITIES

The Business is responsible for:

- providing information to employees about accommodation and return-to-work assistance;
- identifying and eliminating barriers that may prevent an employee from performing his or her job;
- managing employee requests for accommodation in a timely, confidential and sensitive manner;
- ensuring that appropriate individuals are involved in the accommodation process;
- informing individuals as to what information and documentation they need to provide to facilitate the accommodation process; and,
- initiating discussions about accommodations with employees or job applicants where appropriate.

EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITIES

Employees are responsible for:

- making their accommodation needs known to management;
- helping to identify potential accommodation options;
- providing information and documentation in support of their request for accommodation;
- accepting the accommodation solution that meets their needs, even if it is not their preferred accommodation option; and,
- informing the Business of any changes to their needs to allow it to properly assess and revise any accommodation, if required.

Confidentiality

CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

In the course of your employment, you may receive confidential information about the Business and its clients (including client names and contact information) and employees (collectively, “confidential information”). Disclosure of any confidential information would be highly detrimental to the Business’ best interests. As such, all employees, volunteers and other agents shall:

- Take precautions to protect and maintain all confidential information;
- Only release confidential information to those authorized to receive it;
- Not disclose, publish or distribute (including by way of social media) confidential information to any unauthorized persons, including the media, at any time;
- Not remove confidential information from its premises or your workplace without its express permission;
- Not make improper use of confidential information, either directly or indirectly; and,
- Safeguard against unintentionally disclosing confidential information – that is, by not discussing confidential information in public and by not working with confidential information on a laptop in public or transmitting such information by unsecured means.

When your employment ends, you must immediately return all materials or property belonging to the Business. You agree not to retain, reproduce or use any confidential or proprietary information or property belonging to the Business, including lists of its clients and/or employees.

HANDLING CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

The following rules govern how all employees, independent contractors, volunteers, and other agents shall handle and store confidential information:

1. Confidential information shall be circulated in sealed envelopes or storage cases.
2. Address and mark confidential envelopes with the words “PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL”. These envelopes are to be opened only by the persons to whom they are addressed or by persons designated by management as being responsible for handling confidential material.
3. If applicable, handle confidential information with care and, where appropriate, place documents in the shredding receptacles located throughout the office.
4. If applicable, when faxing confidential material, the sender should inform the intended recipient and confirm that the fax machine is intended to receive confidential information. Where possible, fax numbers should be programmed into the speed dialling feature of fax machines to avoid the risks of misdialing.
5. At the end of the working day, individuals must lock doors, desks, filing cabinets and any other storage cabinets containing confidential information. Such cabinets and storage facilities must always be closed and secure.

PROTECTION OF ELECTRONIC DATA

If applicable, the following rules govern the handling of electronic data:

1. Individuals must log off their computer at the end of every shift or workday or when they are to be away from their desks for an extended period of time.
2. Computer passwords are to be changed semi-annually.
3. Individuals must safeguard and must not disclose their computer access codes or any other access mechanisms they have. In that regard, each person is responsible for all activity that occurs while using their access codes or other mechanisms, except where this information was obtained by fraudulent means and the individual in question could not have prevented such unauthorized use through diligent precautionary measures.
4. Where possible, computer monitors should be positioned so that they cannot be seen easily by anyone other than the user.

BREACHES OF CONFIDENTIALITY

Anyone who becomes aware of a breach of confidentiality, or who suspects that a breach has occurred, must report the incident to their manager or to another member of management immediately. An investigation will then be conducted as expeditiously as possible to determine how the breach occurred and, if possible, who was responsible for the breach.

Anyone who becomes aware of an unauthorized or fraudulent use of their access codes or access mechanisms must immediately notify their manager or another member of management.

ACCESS TO PERSONNEL FILES

All personnel files are private and confidential. Unless specifically provided for in this policy, or as may be required by law, no person shall be permitted to access to these files.

Employees may be permitted reasonable and timely access to their personnel file upon submitting a request to their manager. Personnel files are the property of the Business.

At no time shall such files be removed, copied, or destroyed without appropriate authorization.

USE OF PERSONAL DATA

The *Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act* ("PIPEDA") regulates our use of your personal data, in addition to any other privacy legislation that is applicable. As an employer, it is our responsibility to ensure that the personal data we process in relation to you is done so in accordance with the required principles. Any data held will be processed fairly and lawfully and in accordance with the rights of our employees.

We will process data in line with the applicable legislation in relation to both job applicants and employees.

You have certain rights in relation to your data. More information about these rights is available in our Privacy Policy. We are committed to ensuring that your rights are respected in accordance with the law and have appropriate mechanisms for doing so.

We may ask for your consent for processing certain types of personal data. This includes use of software for tracking human resources and login data. In these circumstances, you will be

fully informed as to the personal data we wish to process and the reason for the processing. You may choose to provide or withhold your consent within the software itself. Once consent is provided, you can withdraw consent at any time.

You are required to comply with all Company policies and procedures in relation to processing data. Failure to do so may result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

Personal Electronic Device Use Policy

GENERAL

The Business recognizes that employees may need their personal electronic device to communicate with family or friends or to obtain information on non-company matters while at work. Use of these devices in the workplace during working hours can interfere with employee productivity and be a distraction in the workplace. The Personal Electronic Device Use Policy (the "Policy") sets out expectations around the use of personal electronic devices by any employee during working hours.

SCOPE

This Policy applies to all employees of the Business.

DEFINITIONS

For the purposes of this policy,

- "Emergency" means a serious situation that requires immediate attention.
- "Personal electronic device" means any device that makes or receives telephone calls or emails, leaves voice messages, sends text messages, selects music, checks social media, or surfs the internet; includes cell phones, tablets, laptops, computers, or any similar electronic device.
- "Use" includes checking/sending texts or emails, answering/making phone calls, checking social media, surfing the internet, playing games, or any other use.

POLICY STATEMENT

Employees are permitted to use their personal electronic devices during working hours strictly for business purposes. Personal use of electronic devices is not permitted to ensure full focus on job responsibilities and workplace productivity.

CONTRAVENTIONS OF THE POLICY

Repeated contraventions of the Policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

Drug and Alcohol Policy

GENERAL

Employees are strictly prohibited from reporting to work and engaging in work while impaired by drugs, alcohol or other substances (including cannabis) which may cause impairment.

The use, possession, transfer, or sale of any illegal substance on our premises or in any parking lot or work site is strictly prohibited.

However, if any employee requires accommodation due to a disability (such as substance abuse issues) or as a result of being prescribed medically required drugs (including cannabis), the worker should immediately report his or her condition to management in confidence.

DEFINITIONS

“Impairment” or “being impaired” means that an employee’s normal physical or mental abilities, or faculties, while at work have been detrimentally affected by the use of substances (legal or illegal, including cannabis) as determined by the Business in its sole discretion. Without limiting the generality of the foregoing, “impairment” includes the inability to perform work duties safely, competently, or efficiently.

APPLICATION

Employees must be fit for work at all times, without becoming unfit due to drug or alcohol use. An employee must not attend work or perform work while unfit due to drug or alcohol use.

Any employee who reports for work impaired will not be allowed to work and any worker who is found to be impaired while working will not be allowed to continue working. Employees must not use drugs or alcohol during work hours or during breaks from work. If, in the opinion of management, the employee is considered impaired, the employee shall be sent home by taxi or another safe means of transportation. An impaired employee shall not be allowed to drive under any circumstances.

Subject to any overriding obligations at law (such as a duty to accommodate a disability), any employee who violates this policy by either reporting to work impaired, becoming impaired at work or working while impaired is guilty of serious workplace misconduct and can be subject to severe disciplinary action including immediate dismissal for cause.

The Business recognizes that an addiction to drugs, alcohol, or other illegal substances can qualify as a “disability” for purposes of human rights legislation and will accommodate any disability up to the point of undue hardship.

Internet and Email Policy

GENERAL

The Business owns and controls all workplace technology and information technology resources and systems. If applicable, each employee has a responsibility to use workplace information technology resources and systems in a manner that is consistent with the objectives of their employment.

Employees should have no expectation of privacy regarding any information or data that is received, stored, or transmitted via workplace technology and information technology resources and systems. In addition, employees have no ownership or proprietary interest in any information or data that is received by, stored on, or transmitted with any workplace technology or information technology resources and systems.

Information technology resources and systems refer to the following non-exhaustive list:

- Personal computers and workstations;
- Internal office instant messenger;
- Laptop computers;
- Data storage devices;
- Computer hardware;
- Peripheral equipment, such as printers, modems, fax machines and copiers;
- Computer software applications and associated files and data, including software that grants access to external services such as the Internet;
- Electronic mail (email);
- Cellular telephones and pagers;
- Personal digital assistants and smartphones; and,
- Voicemail systems.

Except as provided in this policy, the use of information technology resources and systems is strictly limited to work-related purposes. Non-business personal use is strictly prohibited.

Any attempt to degrade the performance of a computer system or network or to deprive authorized personnel of resources or access to any of our computer or network is prohibited and will result in discipline up to and including dismissal.

INAPPROPRIATE USE OF I.T. RESOURCES AND SYSTEMS

Inappropriate use of information technology resources and systems includes but is not limited to the following:

- Illegal activity, including breach of copyright laws;
- Accessing inappropriate websites, including but not limited to sites containing pornographic and hate literature;
- Online gambling or other game playing;

- Using technology to harass, discriminate or make defamatory, slanderous or libellous statements (e.g. sexually explicit or racial messages and/or jokes);
- Online shopping or bidding on online auctions;
- Accessing chat rooms and instant messaging;
- Flooding or spamming;
- Downloading, installing or using unlicensed software;
- Signing guest books, newsgroups or bulletin boards; and,
- Conducting personal business, such as online banking.

EMAIL USE

The use of email is reserved primarily for business use. Limited personal use of email is permissible if such use is reasonable and not in contravention of this policy with respect to inappropriate use of information technology resources and systems. Even when used for limited personal use, the content of any email communication sent, received or stored remains the property of the Business at all times.

Smoke-free Workplace Policy

GENERAL

The Business is committed to creating a safe, healthy, and comfortable workplace for all its employees and visitors. The Smoke-Free Workplace Policy (the “Policy”) sets out the Business’ prohibition on smoking in the workplace and assists the Business in complying with the *Smoke-Free Ontario Act, 2017*.

SCOPE

This Policy applies to all employees of the Business.

DEFINITIONS

For the purposes of this policy,

- “Smoking” means:
 - Inhaling and exhaling or holding lighted tobacco or cannabis (medical or recreational); and
 - Inhaling and exhaling the vapor produced by an electronic cigarette or similar device, whether or not the vapour contains nicotine.
- “Workplace” includes but is not limited to:
 - All company-controlled premises, including but not limited to offices, meeting rooms, waiting rooms, washrooms, lounges, dining rooms, and immediate surrounding areas; and,
 - All non-company-controlled premises where an employee is performing work for, and on behalf of, the business.

POLICY STATEMENT

Smoking in the workplace is strictly prohibited. All employees and visitors must comply with and support the Policy.

CONTRAVENTIONS OF THE POLICY

Repeated contraventions of the Policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

Social Media Policy

GENERAL

The Business recognizes that social media use is widespread and that employees use social media to communicate and interact with others. The Social Media Policy (the “Policy”) is intended to safeguard our brand’s reputation and encourage employees to use social media responsibly by setting out expectations around proper online conduct.

SCOPE

This Policy applies to all employees of the Business.

DEFINITIONS

For the purposes of this policy,

- “Social Media” means forms of electronic communication (such as websites for social networking and microblogging) through which users create online communities to share information, ideas, personal messages, and other content; includes but is not limited to LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and any other similar means of communication.
- “Use” Includes posting content or viewing the posts of others, sending/reading messages, watching videos, and any other similar use by means of computer, mobile phone, or any other device.
- “Sensitive, Private, or Confidential Business Information” means Information, knowledge, or data of any nature and in any form relating to the past, current, or prospective business or operations of the Business that, at the time(s) concerned, is non-public information.

POLICY STATEMENT

Employees are prohibited from using social media during working hours and may only do so during their approved breaks or unless otherwise authorized by their manager.

When using social media (whether during approved breaks or outside of work), employees must conduct themselves in accordance with the following rules and expectations:

- Be aware that others will associate you with your employer when you identify yourself as such.
- Do not post or share comments about a co-worker, client, or contractor/vendor that could be perceived as offensive, harassing, threatening, retaliatory, or discriminatory.
- Do not post or share sensitive, private, or confidential Business information.
- Do not express opinions which claim to be the opinion of the Business. Any personal blogs should contain a disclaimer that the views expressed on it are personal views of the author only.
- Do not post or share comments representing your own views about the Business.
- Do not upload photographs to social networking sites of yourself or any other employee taken in a work situation or in a work uniform.

- Respect client privacy. Never give out personal client information.
- Ensure that you are always complying with your employment contract, Employee Handbook, and all other policies of the Business.
- Even if you act with the best intentions, remember that anything you put on social media can potentially harm the Business.
- Always respect others. Do not use ethnic slurs, personal insults, obscenity, or engage in any conduct that would not be acceptable in our workplace. Show proper consideration for the privacy of others and for topics that may be considered objectionable or inflammatory (like religion or politics).
- You may be legally responsible for the content you post, so respect brands, trademarks, and copyrights. Remember that social media sites and applications have access to and control over everything you have disclosed to or on that site or application. Any information might be turned over to law enforcement without your consent or knowledge.
- Use strict privacy settings on all social network profiles.
- Always exercise caution and common sense. If you are unsure whether a post is appropriate, speak to your manager.
- If you accidentally put the Business's reputation at risk, or if you fall prey to an online attack, inform your manager immediately.

MONITORING INTERNET USAGE

The Business may monitor your internet usage regularly and may undertake more in-depth monitoring where considered necessary. This includes monitoring the websites you visit, and any other matters referred to in this Policy.

CONTRAVENTIONS OF THE POLICY

Contraventions of the Policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

Company Cell Phone Policy

The Business provides employees with IT equipment required to perform the functions of their job. The Company Cell Phone Policy (the "Policy") sets out requirements to ensure that employees understand how to use and care for their company-issued cell phone.

SCOPE

This Policy applies to all employees of the Business who have been provided with a company cell phone.

GENERAL

Company cell phones are provided to employees to assist them in the performance of their job duties in a professional and efficient manner.

The cell phone provided to the employee is property of the Company and must be returned upon termination of employment.

USE OF THE CELL PHONE

- The cell phone must be switched on at all times when an employee is on duty, except during a meeting or other circumstances where the phone needs to be on silent mode.
- The cell phone must be used strictly for business purposes, except in the case of an emergency. The cell phone may be used for personal use. Any personal use that is outside of the standard data/call/text limits may be charged back to you. Only work-related text messages may be sent from the Company cell phone.
- Where applicable, the cell phone's Internet features, including but not limited to Internet browsing, should not be accessed at any time. Any personal use of the Internet may be charged back to the employee.
- Software may not be added to a Company cell phone without prior authorization from management.
- It is illegal to use a cell phone while driving, including such activities as making and receiving calls, texting, playing music, and using apps. The cell phone should only be used via a hands-free device such as wireless or Bluetooth. The Company strongly discourages any use of a cell phone while driving. If cell phone use is required, the employee should pull over to the side of the road in an appropriate place.

MONITORING USE

The Business reserves the right to monitor all use of Company cell phones, including all communication made using any means (e.g. text message, email, Internet, or any application). Accordingly, employees should have no expectation of privacy when using a Company cell phone. The Company's policy regarding inappropriate Internet use is set out in the Internet and Email Policy in the Employee Handbook.

VACATION

An employee cannot take their Company cell phone on vacation without the prior authorization of management.

During an employee's vacation, the cell phone's voicemail must be changed to reflect the vacation status, including instructions regarding who a client can contact for assistance.

SAFEKEEPING AND LOST/STOLEN CELL PHONE

Employees are responsible for the safe-keeping of their Company cell phone, ensuring that its batteries are fully charged and that it remains in good condition.

If the Company cell phone or its accessories break due to the wear and tear of regular usage, employees must notify management.

If a Company cell phone or its accessories are damaged due to the employee's own negligence, the employee may be responsible for the cost of a replacement phone.

Employees must immediately report a lost or stolen cell phone to management.

CONTRAVENTIONS OF THE POLICY

Contraventions of the Policy may lead to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Schedule “A”: Employment Classification (Full-Time vs. Part-Time)

The organization defines full-time employment as maintaining an average of twenty-five (25) client-facing (billable) hours per week. Employees who consistently work fewer than 25 billable hours per week will be classified as part-time.

Where billable hours fluctuate, hours will be averaged and rounded based on the previous month's delivered sessions to determine employment status, scheduling, and administrative time allocation. Once additional clients are added to an employee's caseload, schedules and classifications will be adjusted accordingly. The organization reserves the right to reclassify roles based on sustained caseload trends and operational needs.

Schedule B: Client-Facing & Administrative Hours Allocation

To support ethical service delivery, documentation quality, and sustainability, administrative time is allocated in relation to client-facing workload. Administrative time includes documentation, meetings, training, supervision, quality assurance activities, and required non-direct service duties.

Weekly allocation is structured as follows:

Weekly Client-Facing Hours	Weekly Administrative Hours	Total Weekly Hours
15	1	16
20	2	22
25	5	30
30	5	35
Above 30	Adjusted as needed	37.5 max

Total combined hours (client-facing + administrative) for full-time employees will not exceed 37.5 hours per week, unless explicitly approved by management in writing.

Employees on “guaranteed hours” remain hourly employees, not salaried, and guaranteed hours may include both direct client time and approved administrative duties.

Daily Work Structure, Breaks & Downtime

To support regulation, productivity, and ethical practice, workdays are structured as follows:

Unpaid Breaks:

Employees scheduled for full workdays receive one (1) unpaid break per day, in accordance with the Ontario Employment Standards Act.

Daily Administrative Time:

Employees working above 25 billable hours per week are scheduled one (1) hour of administrative time per workday.

Employees working 25 or fewer billable hours per week are scheduled 30 minutes of administrative time per workday, totalling approximately 1.5–2 hours per week, depending on days worked.

Built-In Downtime:

Schedules are intentionally structured to include approximately 1.5–2 hours of downtime per day, distributed within operating hours of 9:00 a.m. to 6:30 p.m., where possible. Downtime supports transitions, preparation, documentation, and reduces the need for after-hours work. Downtime may vary based on caseloads, cancellations, and operational needs.

Documentation, Reporting & Administrative Accountability:

Accurate and timely documentation is an essential job requirement.

Session documentation must be completed within 12 hours of session completion.

Assessments must be completed within 24–48 hours, with finalized reports available to families via the online portal within seven (7) calendar days.

Administrative time must be verifiable, documented, and directly related to approved job duties. The organization reserves the right to deny payment for undocumented or unapproved administrative time and, where applicable, may assert a claim of unjust enrichment for administrative hours reported but not substantiated through required documentation, records, or deliverables.

Schedule C: Performance Feedback & Bonus Structure (Group Contingency)

Employees are expected to participate in timely and accurate feedback processes when requested. Documentation quality, responsiveness, and accountability are essential components of performance evaluation.

The organization maintains a group contingency-based bonus structure, allowing eligible employees the potential to earn approximately \$1,200–\$2,400 per year, based on overall team performance.

This bonus structure is collective and depends on shared responsibility, consistency, and accountability across the team. Individual adherence to documentation timelines, administrative accuracy, and feedback participation directly impacts team eligibility and sustainability of bonuses.

Schedule “D”: Employee Acknowledgement Form

I confirm that I have received and had an opportunity to read a copy of the Employee Handbook. I acknowledge that I understand all the rules, policies, terms and conditions contained in the policy and that failure to abide by the aforesaid, rules, policies, terms and conditions may result in discipline up to and including the termination of my employment for just cause.

I further acknowledge that the Business reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to revoke, change or supplement any of the rules, policies, terms and conditions contained in its Employee Handbook at any time without notice to me.

Employee Name: _____

Employee Signature: _____

Date: _____



Vacation request form



Statutory Leave Notice Form



Non-Statutory Leave Form



Employee Onboarding Form